



JAMIE KELTER DAVIS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Civil Rights Champion, and ‘Our Neighbor’
Yusef Jackson at a service for his father, Jesse Jackson, in Chicago on Friday that drew thousands, including ex-presidents. Page A17.

February Job Losses Signal Trouble for Economy

By SYDNEY EMBER

Hiring fizzled in February, a sign of unexpected weakness in the labor market that sent warning signs flashing through the broader economy.

Employers slashed 92,000 jobs last month, the Labor Department reported on Friday, with losses cutting across nearly all major sectors. The unemployment rate ticked up to 4.4 percent.

The report dimmed the picture of the labor market, injecting a surprising note of caution into an economy already reeling from chaos in energy markets brought on by the war in Iran and fresh unknowns over trade policy. And it all but foreclosed the prospect of a swift resurgence in job growth after an anemic year of hiring that was weighed down by economic uncertainty.

“This is a rough report,” said Cory Stahle, an economist at the Indeed Hiring Lab. “You might even say this is a bad report.”

Many economists had forecast that employers would shake off their reluctance to hire this year, encouraged by surprisingly robust job growth in January. The latest figures signaled that renewed vigor in the economy could

But Some Analysts See Glimmers of Hope

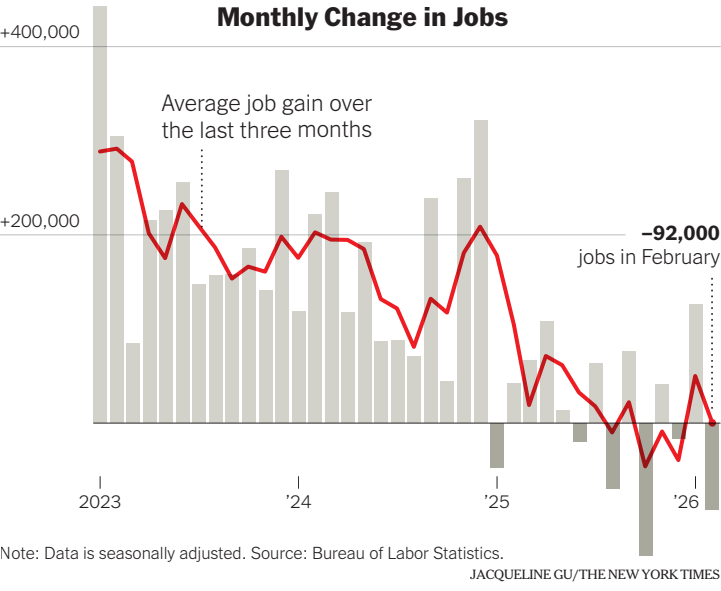
take longer to materialize than anticipated.

Revisions to previous months bolstered the case that the job cuts in February were consistent with a broader decline rather than a blip. In December, employers

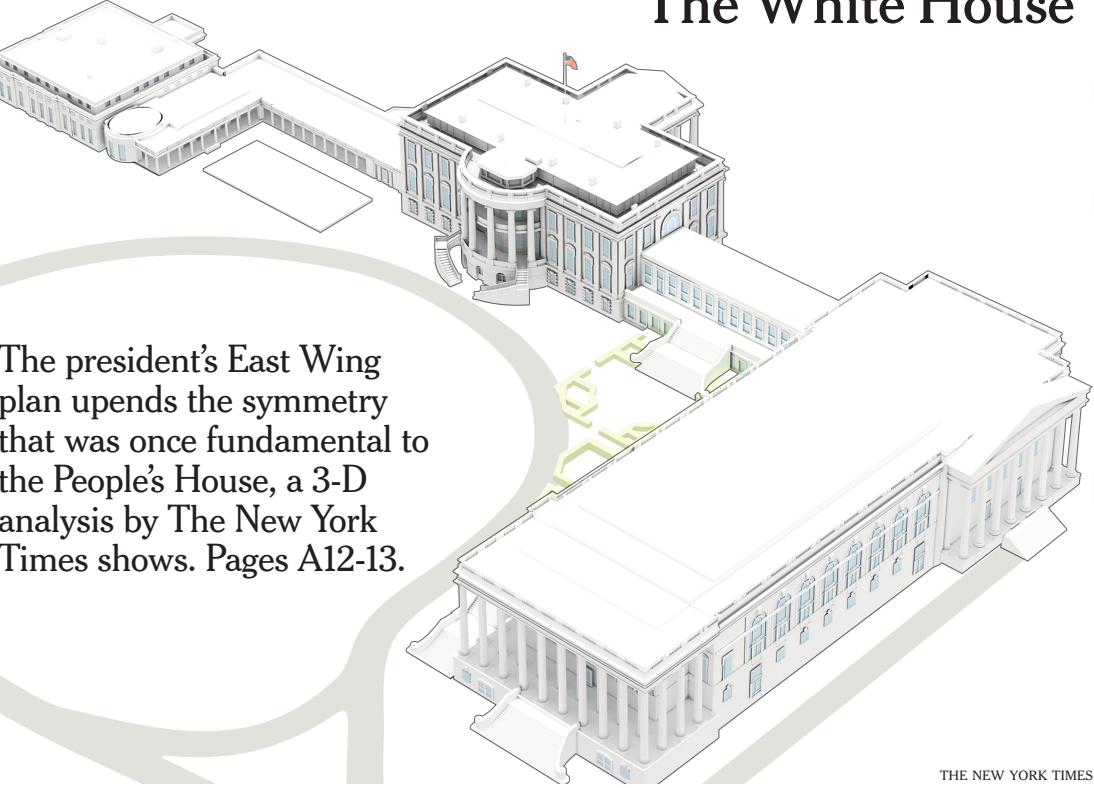
shed 17,000 jobs, down from an earlier estimate of a gain of 48,000, and hiring figures for January were also revised downward slightly, to 126,000. Taken together, job growth for the last three months effectively slowed to zero.

Employment in February fell in industries across the board, including in manufacturing, which lost 12,000 jobs. Leisure and hospitality shed 27,000 jobs. Con-

Continued on Page A16



Trump’s Vision Redraws The White House



The president’s East Wing plan upends the symmetry that was once fundamental to the People’s House, a 3-D analysis by The New York Times shows. Pages A12-13.

U.S. Prepares To Prosecute Cuba Leaders

This article is by **Glenn Thrush, Alan Feuer, Luke Broadwater and Michael Crowley.**

WASHINGTON — The U.S. attorney in South Florida has ordered a broad-ranging inquiry into Cuba’s leaders and Communist Party officials for drug, immigration, economic and violent crimes with a goal of bringing fast indictments, according to three people with knowledge of his actions.

The move comes as President Trump is ratcheting up his rhetorical assault on Cuba’s leadership, and he has gone so far as to recently suggest that he might attack the island nation 90 miles off the Florida coast after he is finished with the Iran war.

Mr. Trump has brought Cuba’s already-frail economy to the brink of total collapse in recent weeks, with the apparent goal of forcing major concessions from Havana. He has cut off Cuba’s oil imports, first by forcing Venezuela to stop shipping oil to its longtime Caribbean ally after the United States captured its leader, Nicolás Maduro, in early January.

Later that month, Mr. Trump issued an executive order threatening tariffs on any other nation that supplied oil to Cuba, leading Mexico, Cuba’s last significant oil supplier, to halt shipments. He has also spoken openly about his desire for the United States to have a “friendly takeover” of Cuba.

Bringing criminal cases against Cuban leaders could provide a legal and political rationale for such action, just as the Justice Department’s indictment against Mr. Maduro, and his wife, Cilia Flores,

Continued on Page A10

Trump Says Surrender Must Be Unconditional For Any Deal With Iran

NEWS ANALYSIS

A Feeble Pitch for a War Tough to Sell

By PETER BAKER

WASHINGTON — President Trump likes to assert that he has accomplished things no other president has. With the opening of his military assault against Iran, he has achieved another distinction: He is the first president in the era of modern polling to take the United States to war without the support of the public.

Traditionally, Americans stand behind their president when he first orders troops into battle, sticking with him unless it drags on, casualties mount and victory seems increasingly elusive. With Mr. Trump’s war against Iran, the public has skipped the rally-around-the-president phase this time.

Support for his ferocious bombardment of Iran has ranged from 27 percent in a Reuters/Ipsos poll to 41 percent in a CNN survey, far below the level of public backing that Mr. Trump’s predecessors initially enjoyed when they used force overseas. Given that wars tend to grow less popular over time, the initial negative response portends political challenges for Mr. Trump and his fellow Republicans the longer the fighting continues.

The opposition is revealing about this particular moment in American history. A country already tired of decades of combat in the Middle East has shown little appetite for yet another adventure abroad. And the deep polarization of American politics only makes it harder to build support across lines. Even some Americans sympathetic to the goal of toppling the repressive, terrorist-sponsoring government

Continued on Page A9

STRANDED Many faulted the State Department for failing to help Americans in the region. PAGE A10

A Demand Follows Tehran’s Mention of ‘Mediation’

This article is by **David E. Sanger, Adam Rasgon, Euan Ward and Richard Pérez-Peña.**

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Friday demanded Iran’s “unconditional surrender,” the latest and broadest expansion of his goals for the war, while Israeli jets pummeled Tehran and other parts of Iran with a fresh wave of airstrikes.

The Israeli military also pounded Beirut and issued more evacuation warnings in Lebanon as it intensified its campaign there against the Iranian-backed militant group Hezbollah. About 300,000 people in Lebanon have fled their homes since the bombing began, according to an estimate by the Norwegian Refugee Council, a humanitarian group.

Mr. Trump wrote on Truth Social that there “will be no deal with Iran except UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER!” He wrote the post after Masoud Pezeshkian, the Iranian president, said that some countries had begun “mediation efforts,” without elaborating on who was involved.

Mr. Trump’s comments were the latest in the shifting goals he has laid out for the war, which have left his aides and congressional allies struggling to keep up and, at times, contradicting him. Indeed, just a few hours after his comments, Karoline Leavitt, the White House press secretary, tried to temper them by saying that Iran’s “unconditional surrender” would come when Mr. Trump “determines that Iran no longer poses a threat to the United States of America and the goal of Operation Epic Fury has been fully realized.”

As the war has gone on for about a week, the fallout for American consumers has been increasing. The fighting has essentially throttled tanker traffic in the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow

Continued on Page A9

A Globe-Trotting U.S. Citizen Landed in a Venezuelan Hell

By ANNIE CORREAL and ANATOLY KURMANAEV

There was one last place to go before James Luckey-Lange could say he had visited every country in the continental Americas: Venezuela.

U.S. officials had been warning with increasing urgency that Venezuela was off limits to Americans. Its authoritarian regime had been capturing U.S. citizens to use as pawns in negotiations.

But Mr. Luckey-Lange, 28, had disregarded such warnings before. In a Haiti overrun by gangs, he sold fruit at a roadside stand. In Nicaragua, he worked on a coffee farm and taught martial arts, though U.S. officials had said

Americans also risked arbitrary detention there.

He said he had assumed that in Venezuela, as in other countries he had visited, the main hazard was random crime, not the government.

So Mr. Luckey-Lange said he felt no particular sense of danger when he climbed onto a motorcycle taxi in Brazil on Dec. 7 and crossed the border.

He was detained the next day.

What followed, he said, was an ordeal unlike anything he could have imagined. Instead of quickly checking Venezuela off his list, he

Continued on Page A6

Robotaxis Tangled in Red Tape of Albany Politics

By BENJAMIN ORESKES and STEFANOS CHEN

Gov. Kathy Hochul made waves in January when she said she would let tech companies start picking up passengers with driverless cars outside of New York City. The planned pilot program would have been a big leap forward for the so-called robotaxi industry, which has already expanded rapidly in some other

Hochul Seeks Union Aid on Car Insurance

states.

A month later, the proposal was gone, stripped from the executive budget with little explanation besides that of a lack of “stakeholder” support.

But the reversal had little to do

with the merits of robotaxis, three people familiar with the discussions said, and more to do with one of Ms. Hochul’s signature priorities for the year: trying to tame New York’s runaway car insurance costs.

The two seemingly unrelated policies have become tangled in a behind-the-scenes squabble that could stall the spread of robotaxi companies like Waymo, since the

Continued on Page A21

ARTS C1-6

Attuned to Harry Styles

The producer- songwriter behind the singer’s sound is also an architect of some of the biggest pop songs. PAGE C1

Painting in a New Light

For Doron Langberg, the war in Gaza forced questions of identity and history to the fore in their work. PAGE C1



NATIONAL A11-21

D.H.S. Pick Has Colorful Past

Markwayne Mullin has a home improvement show, fought in M.M.A. matches and ran a plumbing business before coming to Congress. PAGE A14

Fear of A.I. Energy Backlash

Technology giants are working with the White House, hoping to ease voter concerns over the A.I. boom’s effect on household electric bills. PAGE A11

Defending the Kennedy Center

A congresswoman asked a federal court to block President Trump from shutting down the arts center for two years starting this summer. PAGE A17

INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Memorializing Recent Atrocity

Australia and a small Jewish community are gathering reminders while still trying to process the massacre at Bondi Beach that’s “not history yet.” PAGE A4

More Than Oil in Venezuela

The country has large reserves of valuable minerals that the Trump administration wants control over. PAGE A6

TRAVEL C7-9

36 Hours in Las Vegas

Visitors are drawn to many newfangled thrills in a city that keeps reinventing and reinvesting in itself. PAGE C9

SPORTS B7-10

Wanting to Stay a Met

Freddy Peralta, an ace pitcher, seeks a long-term deal. The team president hesitates to give them. PAGE B10

More Medals to Be Won

The 2026 Winter Paralympic Games kicked off in Verona, Italy, where the Olympics ended last month. PAGE B7



BUSINESS B1-6

Women Wooed by A.I.

As China grapples with a shrinking population and a low birthrate, people are falling for chatbots. PAGE B1

U.S. Gas Prices Jump Again

A gallon of gasoline hits its highest level in months, and surging oil prices suggest it’s only going up. PAGE B3

OPINION A22-23

Michelle Cottle

PAGE A22

